

Unix and Bash exercises

NUnix · L3 MIAGE · TD

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Exercise session



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1. Filename patterns
2. Redirections and paths
3. Scripts with arguments and interactive input
4. Search commands

Use a **practice directory** for files that you create or change.
Read commands and predict their effects before executing them.

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Exercise 1: filename patterns



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List the entries in `/usr/bin` whose names:

1. Start with `m`.
2. Start with `m` and have exactly three characters.
3. Start with `m` and have at least three characters.
4. Start with `m` and have an extension after a dot.

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Exercise 2: the initial files



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Directory	Contains
<code>practice/user1/</code>	<code>f1</code> , <code>f2</code> , <code>f3</code>
<code>practice/user2/</code>	<code>f4</code>

The current directory is **`practice/user2/`**.
What relative path names user1's file `f1`?

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Exercise 2: redirections with cat



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Using `cat` and redirections:

1. Create `f5` containing the line `5 2 3 -1`.
2. Create `f6` from `f4`, followed by `f5`.
3. Append user1's `f1` to `f6`.
4. Copy user1's `f2` into a new file `f7` in `user2`.

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Exercise 3: a script with three filenames



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Write a script named `execution`, called with `n1 n2 n3`.

Step	Input	Program	Output
1	File <code>n1</code>	<code>p1</code>	File <code>n1.r1</code>
2	File <code>n2</code>	<code>p1</code>	File <code>n2.r1</code>
3	<code>n2.r1</code> , then <code>n1.r1</code>	<code>p2</code>	File <code>n3</code>

`p1` and `p2` read **`stdin`** and write **`stdout`**.
Concatenate the two intermediate files in the stated order.

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Exercise 3: resolving the paths

Directory	Contains
practice/user1/	file1, file2, p1, p2, execution
practice/user2/	Another file named file2

From practice/user1/, run:

```
./execution file1 ../user2/file2 fileN
```

Which files are read? Where do the three output files appear?

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Exercise 3: interactive input

Write another version of execution that asks the user for:

- ▶ The first input filename.
- ▶ The second input filename.
- ▶ The output filename.

Keep the same processing steps and concatenation order.

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Exercise 4: script arguments

Write argument, using `expr` to update a counter.

```
./argument one two three
```

Expected output:

```
3 arguments:
argument 1 - one
argument 2 - two
argument 3 - three
```

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Exercise 5: finding a pattern

Write `mysearch`, called with a pattern and a filename:

```
./mysearch 'error' application.log
```

Print either:

- ▶ application.log has the pattern
- ▶ application.log does not have the pattern

Handle an unreadable or missing file as an **error**.

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Exercise 5: repeated searches

1. Write `mysearch2` filename. Ask for a pattern repeatedly until the user enters **end**.
2. Write `mysearch3` f1 ... fn. Search the supplied files for each entered pattern.

Where does each loop belong? What happens when input reaches EOF?

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Exercise 6: reading find commands

Explain each command. Identify unnecessary directory visits or ambiguous patterns.

```
find /var/log -exec grep 'www.athabasca.com' {} \;
find . -name 'rc.conf' -exec chmod o+r {} \;
find /usr/local -type f -name '*.html'
```

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Exercise 6: who handles the redirection?



Analyse this command before running it:

```
find . -name 'tp2' -exec {} < f_in > {}.out \;
```

1. Which program opens `f_in` and `{}.out`?
2. Does `find` replace `{}` inside the redirection filename?
3. How would you give each matching program its own output file?

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